

Skills

Performing a Complete or Partial Bed Bath

Checklist

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S = Satisfactory U = Unsatisfactory NP = Not Performed

Step	S	U	NP	Comments
Procedure Steps	☐	☐	☐	
Verified the health care provider's orders.	☐	☐	☐	
Gathered the necessary equipment and supplies.	☐	☐	☐	
Performed hand hygiene.	☐	☐	☐	
Provided for patient privacy.	☐	☐	☐	
Introduced yourself to the patient and family if present.	☐	☐	☐	
Identified the patient using two identifiers. Compared these identifiers with the information on the patient's identification bracelet.	☐	☐	☐	
Explained the procedure to the patient and ensured that he or she agreed to the treatment.	☐	☐	☐	
Assessed the patient's tolerance for bathing and activity, cognitive ability and musculoskeletal function. Assessed for shortness of breath. Assessed the condition of the patient's skin.	☐	☐	☐	
Encouraged the patient to void before beginning the bath. Offered the patient a bedpan or urinal.	☐	☐	☐	
Applied clean gloves.	☐	☐	☐	
Arranged all supplies on the overbed table.	☐	☐	☐	
Raised the bed to a comfortable working height. Lowered the rail on your side, and helped the patient assume a comfortable supine position, maintaining body alignment.	☐	☐	☐	

Placed a bath blanket or towel over the patient. Had the patient hold the top of the bath blanket or towel, and removed the top sheet from beneath the bath blanket or towel without exposing the patient. Placed soiled linen in the dirty linen bag.

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Removed the patient's gown or pajamas, kept the patient covered with the bath blanket or towel.

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Raised the side rails and adjusted the bed to a comfortable working height for the bath.

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Filled a washbasin two thirds full of warm water. Checked the water temperature. Removed the pillow if the patient's condition allowed. Raised the head of the bed 30 to 45 degrees. Placed a bath blanket or towel under the patient's head. Placed a second bath towel over the patient's chest.

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Washed the face.

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Washed the arms and trunk.

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Washed the abdomen.

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Washed the legs and feet.

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Washed the back.

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Applied body lotion to the skin as needed and covered the patient with a bath towel.

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Straightened the patient's gown, or, if not done earlier, put a clean gown or pajamas, or other clothing on the patient by dressing the affected side first.

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Assisted the patient with additional grooming, if desired. Combed the patient's hair. Female patients might wish to apply cosmetics.

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Applied clean gloves and made the patient's bed.

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Checked the function and position of external devices, such as indwelling catheters, nasogastric tubes, intravenous tubes, and braces.

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Replaced the call light, and neatly arranged personal possessions. To ensure the patient's safety, placed the bed in the locked, low position with at least two but no more than three side rails raised.

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Disposed of used supplies and equipment.

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Performed hand hygiene.

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Documented and reported the patient’s response and expected or unexpected outcomes.

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Learner: _____
Evaluator: _____
Date: _____

Signature: _____
Signature: _____